

FAQs

Msvcrt.dll revisited

Q. I am unable to set up some software on my computer. The error message I get is, "The MSVCRT.DLL file is linked to missing export NTDLL.DLL rtGetNtVersionNumbers."

Sudhanshu Bhasin

A The problem is simple, the software you've installed isn't meant for Windows 98. Certain software were designed for Windows 2000 and later, and won't run on windows 98.

However, it's also possible that the program you're trying to install now isn't the culprit. If you tried to install software earlier that was meant for the NT platform, it could have corrupted your MSVCRT.DLL file, or installed the wrong version.

To fix this, you need to extract the MSVCRT.DLL file from the CD, and overwrite the one in the `\Windows\System\` folder. This should solve the problem.

Unwanted visitors

Q. I have a Windows 98 SE machine. I use Internet Explorer 6. One day after browsing a few Web sites, my homepage became 'www.4-counter.com'. I replaced it with 'about:blank', and also reset all Web settings to their defaults. But after rebooting, the default homepage again became www.4-counter.com. What is the problem? How can I reset my homepage to a blank page?

Raj

A To solve the problem, you'll need to modify the registry. This is a risky affair, so be careful. Open the Registry Editor by executing '`regedit`' at the Run prompt. Now search and delete each key that has a value of '`http://www.4-counter.com`'.

Alternatively, you can search and remove spyware applications using spyware removal tools such as Spybot (included in this month's 101 Freeware CD).

Summer heat

Q. I have a system with an AMD Athlon 1800 MHz, an ASUS motherboard, and 256 MB of DDR RAM. The problem is that the CPU fan overheats. How can I rectify this?

S Palani

A Only use the original fan and heatsink that was provided with the CPU. If need be, you can purchase better cooling solutions from third-party vendors.

As a precautionary measure, verify that excessive amounts of dirt haven't accumulated on the fan blades. You may need to clean the fan carefully with a paint brush. If you have to remove the fan to clean it, be careful and snap it out carefully.

Use thermal paste to increase heat dissipation—remember, too thick a layer of thermal paste can act as an insulator and make matters worse. Sometimes, keeping the cabinet open may help.

Threaded one. Do you recommend the exchange, or should I make do with my present configuration? I intend switching to a HyperThreaded motherboard since it's relatively faster, and supports multitasking.

Can you recommend motherboards that are better than the one I have in mind. If so, please suggest some that have an external AGP slot, as I have a graphics card. Also, please let me know the cost involved.

Siddharth

A Intel's HyperThreading technology pertains to processors and not to motherboards.

Intel's latest CPUs have this feature, and nearly all new motherboards for

the Pentium 4 platform support it.

As far as performance goes, there will be a marginal gain, and that, only with applications optimised for HyperThreading. Unfortunately, as of today, there are very few such applications. Another good point to note is that, some applications actually see a performance drop when used with HyperThreaded processors.

However, you have a pretty decent machine and there is absolutely no reason to shift to a newer configuration as of now.

Back up Outlook Express files

Q. I have Window 98 SE and Outlook Express 6. I need to know how to save, or copy my e-mails from Outlook to a CD.

Neeraj Mishra

A To back up files, first start Outlook Express, then go to **Tools > Options**, and click on Maintenance. Next, click on Store Folder, copy the path, and paste it into Windows Explorer. Finally,

copy all files to the backup location.

Restoring is simple: copy the files back to the original folder.

Monitor starts!

Q. We switch off the monitor when listening to music or running anti-virus software. However, to our surprise, the system automatically shuts down when we switch it back on. How do we solve this problem?

Arnab and Smita

A Get your power supply checked at a good service centre, as it's faulty. It's unable to take the load when you start the monitor, thus triggering off a restart. You may even need to replace the SMPS with another with a higher power rating.



Open the store location in explorer and copy the files



sos@jasubhai.com
E-mail us your computing problems, and we may answer them here! Since we get more

mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!